Statement II: CORRECT—The pace of building irrigation infrastructure has been slow and has constrained progress in agricultural productivity. New seed varieties and fertilizers depend upon regular and timely irrigation to yield results. Progress has not been encouraging, and more attention to irrigation is required to address the gap in productivity between areas with or without irrigation.

67. Statement I: CORRECT—Productivity levels in Indian agriculture vary a lot, sometimes by as much as ten times within the same district or a province, indicating uneven outreach and application of technology, expertise, or other inputs. Such variations are difficult to understand when both areas are equipped with irrigation facilities. Through demonstration effects, training, and visits, it should have been possible to spread good farm practices to holdings that are not performing well quite easily. At the state level, average productivity in lagging states is about 50% of that in the leading states.

Statement II: CORRECT—States with substantial areas under irrigation need to perform better in terms of yields and agricultural productivity. Bihar is a prime example. About two-thirds (67.4%) of the cultivated area is under irrigation yet yields are barely above all India average. Bihar's total production of food grains is only about 13 million tonnes. For jute and mesta, Bihar is a distant second to West Bengal. India could make rapid progress by improving productivity in such areas.

68. Statement I: CORRECT—A significant part of production is lost in the process of marketing due to institutional impediments, the distant location of markets, lack of storage and transportation facilities, and the absence of sorting and grading of produce. To some extent this is because of deficient infrastructure (e.g., cold storage, transport, and rural roads) and to some extent because of excessive regulation under the Agricultural Production Marketing Committee Act (APMC Act). In this context, the Economic Survey 2014-15 observes:

Statement II: CORRECT—At present, the market for agricultural produce is highly segmented and subdivided. There is no national uniform market for agricultural produce in India. As a result, even